

Discharge advice: Following attendance with ankle sprain

Issuing institution: Cambridge University Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust

Publication/review date: Approved 14 January 2025

Original official URL:

<https://www.cuh.nhs.uk/patient-information/discharge-advice-following-attendance-with-ankle-sprain/>

Archive note: English text snapshot of the official patient-information webpage. Navigation was removed; the medical content was not translated.

Discharge advice: Following attendance with ankle sprain | CUH

Patient Information

[Skip to main content](#)

Discharge advice: Following attendance with ankle sprain

Patient information A-Z

[Print this page](#)

You have sprained the ligaments in your ankle.

This commonly causes pain and swelling, and in more severe cases visible bruising. You may also experience weakness.

What should I expect and what can I do to help my ankle to heal?

In the early days after the injury , R.I.C.E (Rest, Ice, Compression, Elevation) reduces the inflammation of the ankle.

As soon as the acute pain and swelling settles normal walking is allowed. It is advisable to wear flat shoes and avoid walking a round on uneven ground.

More strenuous and sporting activities can be introduced gradually when the pain and swelling has settled down and normal walking is comfortable.

Minor sprains recover within a few weeks and do not need specific treatment. More severe sprains may take longer to settle, and sometimes physiotherapy helps in recovering joint movements, muscle strength and stability.

It may take several months for the ankle to feel normal again and for the swelling to disappear completely.

Occasionally the ankle sprain continues to be painful even after several months. In case there are ongoing problems, seeking advice from an ankle specialist is advisable.

Physiotherapy advice

No specific physiotherapy exercises or advice required for this injury.

Document details

Approved

14 Jan 2025

Version number

4

Document ID

101194

Other formats

Help accessing this information in other formats is available. You can find out more about this service on our [patient information](#)

[help page](#).

Service / Department

Trauma and Orthopaedics

We are smoke-free

Smoking is not allowed anywhere on the hospital campus. For advice and support in quitting, contact your GP or the free NHS stop smoking helpline on 0800 169 0 169.

Other formats

Help accessing this information in other formats is available. To find out more about the services we provide, please visit our patient information help page (see link below) or telephone 01223 256998.
www.cuh.nhs.uk/contact-us/accessible-information/

Contact us

Cambridge University Hospitals

NHS Foundation Trust

Hills Road, Cambridge

CB2 0QQ

Telephone +44 (0)1223 245151

<https://www.cuh.nhs.uk/contact-us/contact-enquiries/>